

Writer participant	Summary of participant's definition of authenticity	Quote	Source authenticity (§4.2.1)	Authentic self (§4.2.2)	Content authenticity (§4.2.3)	Value alignment
P13	Authenticity arises from the individuality revealed through one's work. It comes from the author expressing himself/herself to produce their work.	"I really value the expression of other people. [...] Even if the person isn't good at expressing themselves, you're learning something about another person through that work. You're learning something about what took up space in their mind and in their heart. So there's an authenticity to any kind of human generated art versus computer generated art, that to me, that's the main difference."	✓	✓		
P14	Authenticity is the lived experiences that the author had and could instill in their work.	"It [authenticity] is connection to a person's lived experience, a story seen from their point of view. [...] I'm Asian American, so if there was a story written by ChatGPT, and it was about the Asian American experience. The AI could essentially take from sources online to create that, but would it have the true authenticity behind it? And a lot of times authenticity is like your life experience. I could instill the life experiences that I've had to make them [characters in P14's work] feel authentic in their stories."		✓		
P15	Authenticity is expressing oneself through their own unique voice.	"Writing authentically involves expressing yourself authentically, from the inside out. And when someone uses their unique, authentic voice, they write best."		✓	✓	
P16	Authenticity means incorporating and representing one's true self through their work.	"Authenticity for me is representing myself through my writing. When people read my work, they should be able to recognize it without viewing my name. [...] It means bringing forth yourself into your writing. Not to mimic others. Just bring you, your personality and everything into your writing."		✓	✓	
P17	Authenticity reflects one's identity through their work. During the process of writing, one might also reshape their own identity.	"Authenticity is how your sense of self reflects in your writing. Authenticity doesn't mean being opinionated, rather it's recognizing your bias, challenging it, and constantly reshaping your worldview through and in your writing."	✓	✓		
P18	Authenticity is the true self and soul that stand behind a piece of writing.	"Authenticity just comes down to having that soul behind the writing to make it feel like it's compelling and being written by someone who's passionate about what they're writing about. [...] Just having that level of compassion and understanding from a person's perspective, I think makes a big difference in writing."		✓		
P19	Authenticity arises from the individual experiences that allow one to tell stories in their own way.	"Authenticity is your signature, your personalized way of telling a story. [...] Everyone can start with similar ideas but individual experiences allow for personal, unique ways of storytelling."		✓		

take an idea and how it would be different from 50 other people who take the same idea and try to finish it or complete it to the end." (P19)

However, when AI contributes to writing, the content is no longer grounded solely in writers' own experiences, memories, backgrounds, knowledge, research, and more. It is not always clear to them where the writing suggestions were coming from and what they were grounded on, and thus, writers can no longer claim their work as a reflection of their lived experiences or as representative of themselves.

4.2.3 Defining authenticity through writing outcomes (Content authenticity). Examining the outcomes of writing is yet another approach to assessing authenticity. More specifically, authentic writing equals writing that best represents the work of a writer, where one can tell who the writer is by reading the text. This perspective echoes the "category" construct of authenticity, which is the most adopted definition of authenticity in the literary studies space [21, 23, 42]. Nonetheless, it was the least referred to and a less critical construct from writers' points of view. In our study, the few writers who defined authenticity through this lens were concerned about the influences of AI writing assistance on authenticity, as AI's input might "shift writers away from the typical ways of [their] writing practices" (P2), intruding on their usual tones, voices, and ways of presentation in their writing. Under this conception of authenticity, since authenticity in writing is evaluated by comparing it to a writer's representative work, the writers in our study also connected the meaning of authenticity back to various writing elements (e.g., word choice, style, use of references and metaphors) that uniquely characterize their own writing.

4.3 (Re)claiming Authenticity Through Practices of Co-writing with AI

Through the co-writing sessions, writers identified several practices during the writing process that could help shape authenticity in writing with AI assistance. In other words, *how* writers use AI while writing plays a key role in determining the authenticity of AI-assisted writing. These determinants include: (1) whether one starts with a clear vision for writing in mind, (2) when one calls for writing assistance from AI, (3) what portion of contribution one makes in the writing, and (4) what purpose and usage that AI writing assistance serves.

4.3.1 Setting off with a clear vision of what to achieve in one's writing. In describing their writing, nearly all writers reported that they seldom start writing with a blank sheet. Instead, they typically begin their processes with some vision for writing in mind. Such a vision need not be a concrete, fully fleshed-out idea. But writers often already have certain directions or settings in mind that they would like to set up for the passage, given the preparatory work they did before writing (e.g., ideation, research, collecting references and other writing materials). Otherwise, they lack an anchor to cohesively guide how they respond to, select, and curate AI suggestions alongside their own writing. In such a case, writers worried that they might be at more risk of being affected by AI suggestions, depriving their authentic voices in writing.

“I think it [AI] has the possibility to [affect writers] if you let it. But if you already have your ideas of what you want to stay true to, then it isn't going to affect your authentic voice, in my opinion. So to me, it comes down to user influence and how much the user chooses the directions that the AI suggests.” (P4)

4.3.2 Working with AI through the “fuzzy area” of idea development when writing. It is worth recognizing that writers work through various stages throughout their writing processes. While writers bring a premature vision to initiate writing, there is typically a “fuzzy area” (P04) between the starting point and well-developed ideas, which eventually leads to a fully crafted piece of writing. Most writers believe that AI writing assistance is most acceptable and is considered as having the least harm on authenticity at this middle ground for two reasons. First, the ways in which writers would interact with AI writing assistance tools during this stage primarily serve to consolidate and further develop their ideas (we discuss opportunities for AI tools to support writers more extensively in Section 4.3.4). At this stage, writers write to incubate and organize their thinking rather than to produce text to construct the actual piece of writing. Therefore, though AI suggestions contribute pieces of content, they serve as materials that facilitate the thought processes rather than the writing *per se*.

4.3.3 Claiming contribution through content gatekeeping. Most importantly, in our study, most writers considered AI-assisted writing as authentic as long as they contributed more to the writing. Specifically, writers noted that one's *contribution* does not necessarily equal how much text they wrote. In their view, real contributions require “content gatekeeping” (P8)—that is, actively deciding what goes into the writing content. Given this conception of contribution, writers frequently described themselves as doing most of the work during the writing process as they took charge of selecting, revising, and incorporating AI suggestions into their writing. Whether a word, a sentence, or a paragraph is produced with AI assistance or not, it is the human writer, instead of the AI tool, that takes control over whether to adopt, remove, or revise each piece of content.

4.3.4 Beyond AI as a co-writer: Opportunities for supporting authentic writing processes. Besides requesting content suggestions from AI (i.e., what the CoAuthor interface supports), some writers believed they could benefit from AI assistance while preserving their authentic voices by leveraging AI capabilities as *a means of internalization, a driver of*

the writing flow, and *a sounding board of public feedback*. Below, we unpack each of these favorable co-writing forms that our participants indicated:

AI as a means of internalization: Nurturing themselves through reading, researching, and experiencing the world is key to the quality and richness of writers' work. Writers often improve their work over time by reading and getting inspired by others' work. Thus, some writers saw AI as a means to help them absorb large amounts of information and saw AI suggestions as excerpts resulting from this practice. As P18 described:

"The way that we actually improve ourselves is by reading other people's works. Our memory retention on how other people worded things is in the background of our minds when we need to write something of a similar nature. [...] But really what you're doing is regurgitating what you've read maybe 20 years ago, ten years ago, or just five or 4 hours ago, doing it in your own unique way and telling your own unique story. [...] This [AI writing assistance] is kind of combining those two things [reading and writing] all at once. So instead of reading, I'm getting an option which is exactly what the reading is supposed to do for you. And I can choose that option or choose to go with my own authenticity, my own way of actually writing it."

Under this form of AI assistance, some participants saw an analogy with how AI is built (i.e., learning from large amounts of text to produce text): much as human writers consume information and experiences to enrich their writing, AI digests vast amounts of data to generate text—though the machine expedites this process significantly. In other words, while writers gradually take in their work and life experiences to enrich their writing, they saw AI as a potential tool that compresses this process and presents the results of some sort of "internalization." As P10 put it in a critical way, "if what this AI does for the writer is unauthentic, then, perhaps there is no such thing as authentic writing."

AI as a driver of the writing flow: Having the option to continuously request assistance from AI may help carry on writers' writing flow and remove writing blocks. Occasionally, AI suggestions might point to novel directions or ideas that writers would not have conceived of by themselves, and the tool might also offer "jumping points" that allow writers to transition from one idea to another. However, writers valued the AI's apparent capability of "keeping [writers] up with their momentum" (P08) the most. Not only does it take warm-up time for writers to immerse themselves in a smooth writing flow, but once the flow experience is interrupted, it can be difficult to resume. Writers saw AI suggestions as on-demand, temporary remedies when they sensed such an interruption in their writing process.

AI as a sounding board of public feedback: Several writers were aware that large language models are trained with vast amounts of text data across digital outlets. As such, they viewed these models as an assembly of information and opinions online, and would like to use it as a sounding board to potentially project and reflect responses from broader audiences. Some writers saw AI suggestions as syntheses of the public's interests, and they were interested in using such information to navigate and/or improve their own work.

4.4 Finding and Preserving Authentic Voice: Personalization as Double-Edged Sword

While most writers showed preferences toward personalized AI writing assistance, they foresaw both positive and negative influences of personalization. They believed grappling with such dilemmas was key to adopting AI tools in what they dubbed as a more collaborative rather than reliant fashion. In this section, we discuss how writers perceived the impact of personalized AI on their writing, together with whether and how personalization affected their usage behaviors with the tool, and how readers responded to their writings with personalized versus non-personalized AI assistance based on data from the reader survey.